

Employee Leave Policy (2023 Edition)

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1. Overview

This article describes Meridian Robotics' employee leave policy as it applies to all full-time employees. It covers leave entitlements, the request process, and carry-over rules. HR business partners should reference this article when answering employee questions about how much leave they have and how to request it.

Note: This version of the policy was effective from 2023-01-01. It has been superseded by the 2024 edition (see Cross-Article References below). It is retained here for historical reference and for processing leave requests dated before 2024-01-01.

2. Eligibility

All full-time employees are eligible for leave from their date of joining. Interns and contractors are not covered by this policy and should refer to their engagement agreement instead.

3. Leave Entitlements

Leave is split across four categories, each with its own annual entitlement.

3.1 Casual Leave

Casual leave covers short, planned absences (personal errands, family events). The annual entitlement is **12 days**. Casual leave must be requested at least 3 business days in advance through the HR portal.

3.2 Sick Leave

Sick leave covers illness or medical appointments. The annual entitlement is **10 days**. Unlike casual leave, sick leave may be reported on the day of absence rather than in advance; a doctor's note is required for absences longer than 2 consecutive days.

3.3 Earned Leave

Earned leave accrues at a rate of 1.5 days per completed month of service, for an annual entitlement of **18 days**. Earned leave requests must be submitted at least 5 business days in advance.

3.4 Parental Leave

Parental leave is granted at **26 weeks** for the primary caregiver and **2 weeks** for the secondary caregiver, regardless of tenure.

4. Requesting Leave

All leave requests (except same-day sick leave) are submitted through the HR portal under "Time Off > New Request." A request is considered approved once the reporting manager confirms it in the portal; unconfirmed requests auto-escalate to the manager's manager after 3 business days.

5. Carry-Over Rules

Unused earned leave carries over to the next calendar year, up to a maximum of **10 days**. Casual leave and sick leave do not carry over and expire at the end of the calendar year.

6. Frequently Asked Questions

- **Can I take casual leave and sick leave in the same week?** Yes, they are tracked independently.
- **What happens if I don't use my earned leave?** Up to 10 days carry over; anything beyond that is forfeited on December 31.
- **Is parental leave paid?** Yes, at full base salary for the duration listed above.

7. Escalation

Disputes about leave balances should be escalated to the HR Shared Services desk, which will review the employee's accrual history and issue a correction within 5 business days if warranted.

Cross-Article References

- See **Employee Leave Policy (2024 Edition)** for the current entitlements, effective 2024-01-01.
- See **Remote Work Policy** for how remote work days interact with leave requests.
- See **Performance Review Policy** for how extended leave affects review-cycle timing.